

Ciaran Fontein

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SUMMARY

Frontend engineer with 6+ years of professional software development. Sole creator of a production React Native app (React + TypeScript) for a transaction-based employee rewards platform, now used by 10,000+ users. The app holds user balances, sells gift cards in multiple currencies, and handles fund transfers between users. It runs at 99%+ crash-free sessions with a 4+ star store rating on the iOS App Store and Google Play.

Four years of computer science coursework at BCIT, plus those 6+ years shipping production software: equivalent practical experience to a bachelor's degree in Computer Science, though no degree was conferred. Native English speaker, based in Japan, learning Japanese.

SKILLS

React Native (React), TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+) • State management with React Context • REST API integration • Client-side transaction, fund-transfer, and multi-currency UI flows • Frontend performance optimization • Release management • Git / Bitbucket / Jira • Figma (design handoff) • Client-side push notifications • AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Codex) • Technical handover / team onboarding

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Engineer (Contract), Guusto Gifts Inc.

Mar 2020 – Jul 2026

Remote, Canada-based company. Employee rewards platform: a transaction-based product where users hold balances and transfer funds.

- Sole creator of the company's production React Native app, built in React and TypeScript. Shipped to the iOS App Store and Google Play; now used by 10,000+ users.
- Built every client-side transaction flow: user balances, gift-card purchase and spending, currency changes, and fund transfers between users. Kept balance state correct across all of them.
- Client accounts spend hundreds of thousands of dollars per year through the platform (web + mobile combined); the app is a primary consumer channel.
- Owned the client side of the product's high availability and performance requirements for 6+ years. Kept it at 99%+ crash-free sessions and a 4+ star store rating through bug fixes, performance work, and release management.
- Integrated the app with the backend REST APIs for transfers, balances, and purchases.
- Worked with the web, backend, design, and product teams on features that spanned web and mobile.
- Built the app's reusable UI components from Figma handoffs; implemented client-side push notifications.
- Reviewed teammates' pull requests, including Redux state-management refactors.
- Used Claude Code and Codex to speed up development and code review.
- Ran the technical handover and training for the incoming replacement team over the contract's final 3 months.

EDUCATION

British Columbia Institute of Technology (BCIT), Canada

2011 – 2015

Associate's Degree, Computer Information Technology (2011–2013), then a two-year Game Development extension in algorithm optimization and 3D graphics. Coursework: algorithms, databases, human-computer interaction, physics simulation (built physics engines), C++, C#, and Java. Completed all coursework for the bachelor's-level program; the final practicum was not submitted, so the degree was not conferred. With 6+ years of professional software development since, this is equivalent practical experience to a bachelor's degree in Computer Science.

RED Academy, Canada

Jun 2019 – Dec 2019

Six-month, full-time web development program covering React and React Native. Those are the skills I've built on at Guusto since.

WORK AUTHORIZATION

Spouse visa holder in Japan: no visa sponsorship required to work for any employer in Japan.